SUPERSTORE SALES & PROFITABILITY ANALYSIS

From Raw Data to Meaningful Business Insights

Sales Trends | Performance Evaluation | Profit Drivers

Jet Lee Widjaya

Microsoft Excel

UNDERSTANDING BUSINESS PERFORMANCE

01 | *Business Context*

High sales do not always guarantee profitability. This analysis examines sales trends, profit contributions, and performance gaps.

02 | *Analytical Objectives*

Evaluate performance
Identify performance gaps
Investigate profit drivers
Generate business insights

03 | *Analytical Approach*

Data Preparation | **KPI Development** | **PivotTable Analysis** | **Dashboard Design** | **Business Insights**

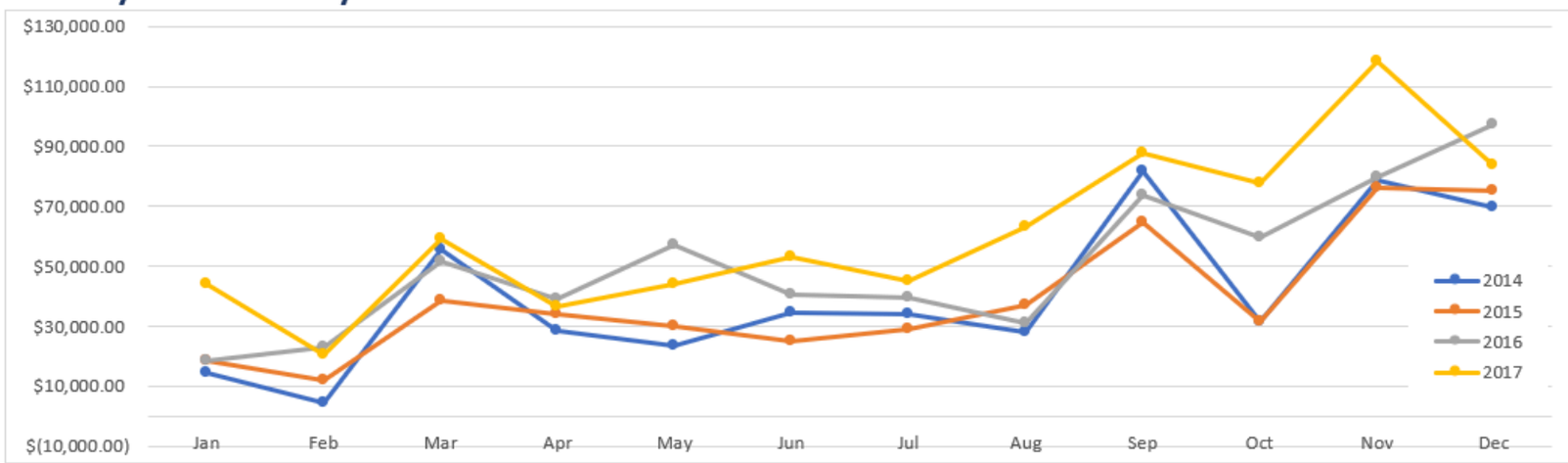
FROM DATA TO DASHBOARD

SuperStore Business Performance Dashboard 2014 - 2017

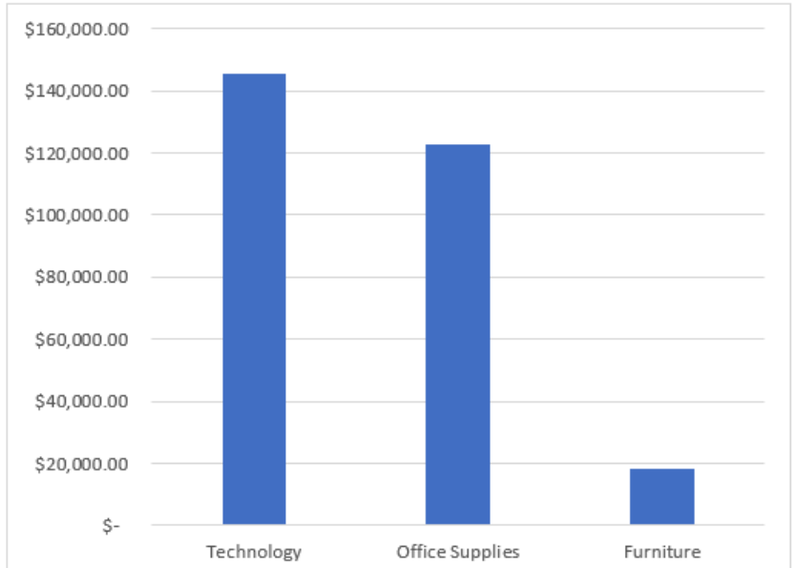
Sales & Profit Performance Analysis | 2014 - 2017

Total Sales	Total Profit	Profit Margin	Total Records
$2.30M	$286.4K	12%	9994

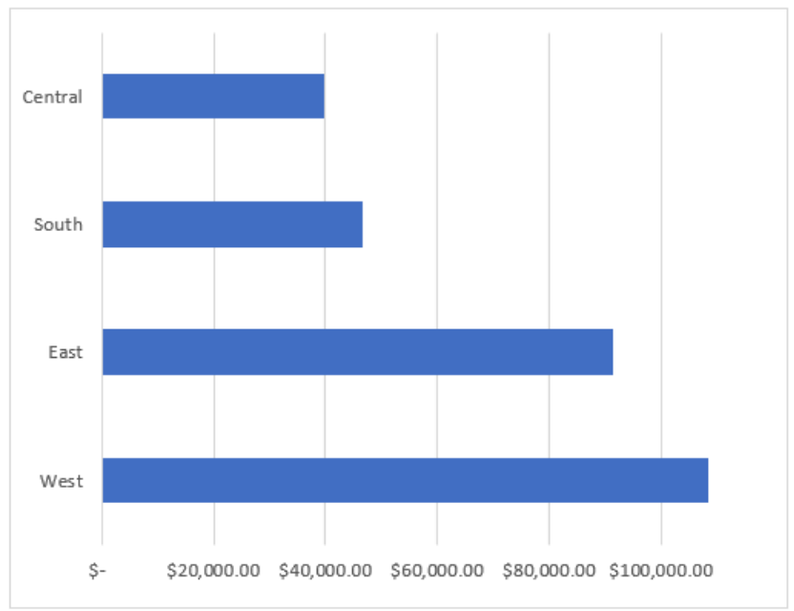
Monthly Sales Trend by Year



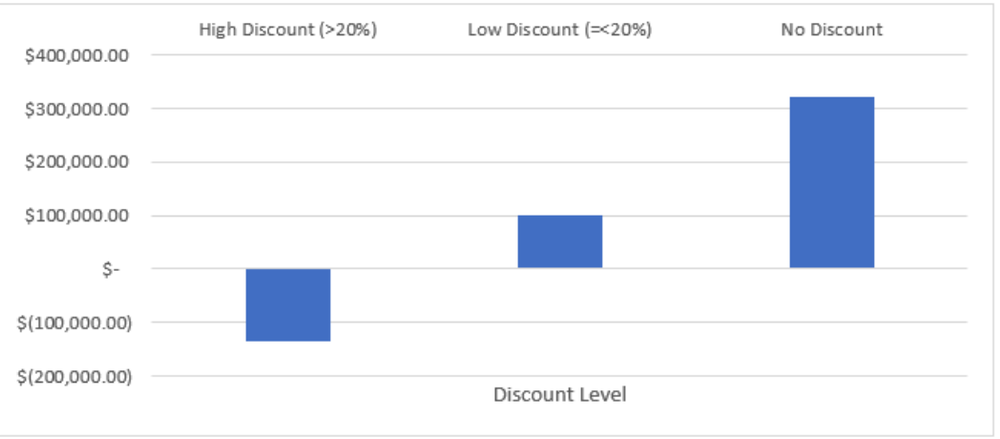
Profit by Category



Profit by Region



Discount Impact on Profit



Key Insights:

- **High discounts (>20%)** drive significant **losses (~$135K).**
- **Technology** leads category profit (~$145K); **Furniture** trails (~$18K).
- **West** is the most **profitable region (~$108K)**, followed by East (~$91K).
- **2017** shows the **strongest sales performance,** peaking in **November (~$118K).**

Sample SuperStore Dataset - Kaggle

WHAT THE DATA REVEALS

01 | Discounting & Profitability

High Discount Losses
-$135k

The contrast between profitable low-discount and loss-making high-discount transactions raises questions about whether aggressive discounting delivers sufficient financial returns to justify its impact on profitability.

02 | Profitability by Category

Technology Profit
$145k

The substantial profit gap between Technology and Furniture suggests potential profitability dependence on stronger-performing categories, while weaker contributors may limit overall profit growth.

03 | Uneven Regional Profitability

West Region Profit
$108k

The profit gap between the West and Central regions suggests that understanding the factors of regional performance differences could reveal opportunities to improve performance in lower-contributing markets.

Figures are approximate.

BUSINESS INSIGHTS TO ACTION

01
Discount Strategy

Establish product-level margin checks for discounts exceeding 20%. Flag promotions projected to generate losses for review before approval.

Intended outcome:
Reduce loss-making promotions without unnecessarily restricting profitable discounts.

02
Category Profit

Improvement efforts on weaker products by identifying Furniture products with recurring losses and assess targeted pricing or promotional adjustments.

Intended outcome:
Improve Furniture's profit contribution through targeted interventions.

03
Regional Performance

Use the West's stronger profit performance as a starting point for comparing products and discount strategies with the Central region to identify relevant business practices.

Intended outcome:
Identify scalable opportunities to improve regional profitability.

Key Takeaway

Effective business decisions require understanding not only where profits are generated, but also where they are lost and how performance can be improved.